

**MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION, SCIENCE AND INNOVATION
OF THE REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN
TERMEZ STATE UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF PHYSICS AND MATHEMATICS**



APPROVED

Dean of the Faculty of Physics and
Mathematics

_____ A.Sh. Safarov

“ ”
_____ 2026

**GUIDELINE FOR HANDLING COMPLAINTS FROM STUDENTS,
FACULTY AND STAFF OF THE UNIVERSITY OR FACULTY**

OFFICIAL TRANSLATION

The Guideline has been developed on the basis of the requirements of the Regulation “On the Procedure for the Competitive Recruitment of Teaching Staff to Higher Education Institutions,” approved by Resolution No. 20 of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated 10 February 2006.

The Guideline was discussed at meeting No. “___” of the Department of Physics, held on “___” _____ 2026, and recommended to the Faculty Council.

Head of Department: _____ A. Narbayev

The Guideline was approved by decision No. “___” of the Council of the Faculty of Physics and Mathematics, dated “___” _____ 2026.

Dean of the Faculty: _____ A. Safarov

CHAPTER 1. GENERAL PROVISIONS

1.1. Purpose of the Guideline

1. This Guideline (hereinafter — the “Guideline”) establishes the procedure for receiving, registering, reviewing and resolving complaints, applications and proposals from students, master’s students, trainees, faculty members and other staff (hereinafter — “complainants”) of the Faculty of Physics and Mathematics of Termez State University (hereinafter — the “Faculty”), for making decisions thereon, and defines the powers of the responsible bodies and officials in this regard.

2. The purpose of the Guideline is to create, within the Faculty, an open, fair, objective, prompt and effective system for handling complaints; to protect the rights and legitimate interests of complainants; to prevent any pressure or discrimination against a person who has filed a complaint; and to ensure the continuous improvement of the education quality assurance system on the basis of complaint analysis.

1.2. Scope of Application

3. The provisions of the Guideline apply to all structural units of the Faculty — the Departments of General and Theoretical Physics, Applied Physics, Mathematical Analysis, Algebra and Geometry, and Applied Mathematics and Informatics, as well as teaching laboratories — and to all categories of complainants, including bachelor’s and master’s students, trainees, faculty members, and research and teaching-support staff.

4. Complaints falling within the scope of the Guideline include those relating to the educational process (including fairness of assessment, laboratory and practical classes, and academic supervision of coursework and final qualifying papers), disciplinary measures, discrimination and disrespect, indications of corruption, labour relations, material and technical provision, infrastructure, and any other matters. Complaints indicating a criminal offence are immediately forwarded to the law-enforcement

authorities in the manner established by legislation, in which case this Guideline applies only to the internal measures taken by the Faculty.

1.3. Regulatory and Legal Basis

5. The Guideline has been developed on the basis of the following documents:

the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education”;

Law No. O'RQ-378 of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Citizens' Appeals,” dated 3 September 2014;

the Labour Code of the Republic of Uzbekistan;

the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Personal Data”;

decrees and resolutions of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan on improving the system for handling appeals, including the regulatory documents on the “Public Reception Offices” and the “Trust Hotline” systems;

the relevant orders and guidelines of the Ministry of Higher Education, Science and Innovation and of the State Inspectorate for Quality Control in Education under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan;

the international standard ISO 10002:2018 “Quality management — Customer satisfaction — Guidelines for complaints handling in organizations”;

the Standards and Guidelines for Quality Assurance in the European Higher Education Area (ESG, 2015 edition), in particular Standards 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 1.7, 1.8 and 1.9;

the recognized practice in handling student and staff complaints of foreign higher education institutions participating in the QS World University Rankings and Times Higher Education (THE) rankings, including those within the TOP-300;

the Charter of Termez State University, its Quality Assurance Policy, and other internal regulatory documents.

6. The Guideline is based on the internationally recognized “three-stage” approach (informal resolution — formal review — independent re-review) and on the core principles set out in ISO 10002 (further detailed in Chapter 13).

1.4. Basic Concepts

7. The following basic concepts are used in this Guideline:

complaint — a written or electronic communication from a complainant concerning a violation of their right, freedom or legitimate interest, or dissatisfaction with the quality of the Faculty’s services;

proposal — an opinion aimed at improving the Faculty’s activities;

informal complaint — a communication resolved promptly through direct communication, without formal registration;

formal complaint — a communication submitted in the prescribed form, registered, and reviewed within the time limits specified in this Guideline;

appeal (request for re-review) — a request by a complainant who disagrees with a decision taken, for its independent re-review;

mediation — a method of resolving a dispute between the disputing parties with the participation of an independent intermediary;

Ombudsperson (Trust Representative) — an independent official responsible for protecting the rights and interests of students and staff;

quality cycle (PDCA — Plan-Do-Check-Act) — in accordance with ESG Standards 1.1 and 1.9, a continuous-improvement cycle based on planning, implementing, checking and improving processes;

conflict of interest — a situation in which the person reviewing a complaint has a personal, family, or professional interest in the subject matter of the complaint;

reprisal (pressure) — any adverse measure taken against a person because that person filed, or participated in filing, a complaint.

CHAPTER 2. CORE PRINCIPLES OF COMPLAINTS HANDLING

8. The complaints-handling system is based on the following principles established in the international standard ISO 10002:2018 and in ESG Standard 1.1 (“policies and processes for quality assurance should have a formal status and be publicly available, and should form part of a cycle of continuous improvement”):

Openness and transparency — information on the procedure, channels and time limits for filing a complaint is made publicly available on the Faculty website, in the student and staff handbook, and in all structural units (ESG Standard 1.8 — information open to the public).

Accessibility — the opportunity to file a complaint is provided to all complainants, including persons with limited abilities, free of charge, in an unobstructed manner and in comprehensible language.

Promptness — every complaint is reviewed within the time limits established in Chapter 7 of this Guideline; delay is not permitted.

Impartiality and fairness — a person with a connection to, or a conflict of interest in, the subject matter of a complaint does not take part in reviewing it; the views of all parties are heard on an equal footing.

No charge — no fee is charged to the complainant for filing or reviewing a complaint.

Confidentiality — information about the complainant and any third parties named is disclosed only to the extent necessary for the investigation and only to authorized officials.

Participation of stakeholders — in accordance with ESG Standards 1.2 and 1.7, students and staff take a direct part in shaping, analyzing and improving the complaints system (a representative of the Student Council is a permanent member of the Faculty Committee).

Responsibility and accountability — a specific responsible person is designated for each stage, and decisions are formalized in writing with reasons given.

Protection from pressure — any pressure, discrimination or other adverse measure against a person who has filed a complaint is strictly prohibited (Chapter 10 of this Guideline).

Continuous improvement (quality cycle) — systemic issues are identified and addressed on the basis of complaints statistics and analysis; the results are discussed by the Faculty Council.

Competence — persons receiving and reviewing complaints undergo special training and possess communication and dispute-resolution skills.

CHAPTER 3. CLASSIFICATION OF COMPLAINTS

3.1. By Subject Matter

related to the educational process (fairness of assessment, the conduct of examinations and assessments, laboratory classes, academic supervision of coursework/final qualifying papers, the curriculum);

administrative-organizational (scholarships, dormitory, document workflow, transfer between departments);

labour relations (appointment to a position, salary, disciplinary sanction, contract terms) — for faculty members and staff;

violations of ethical norms and respect (discrimination, pressure, bullying, mobbing);

indications of corruption (soliciting a bribe, unfair treatment, abuse of position);

infrastructure and material-technical provision (laboratory equipment, classroom conditions);

other matters.

3.2. By Nature of Review (International Practice Classification)

disputes — disagreements regarding administrative decisions, assessment, or service quality;

mismanagement — unjustified decisions, inconsistent application of rules, unfairness;

misconduct — violations of ethics and integrity norms such as plagiarism, fraud, discrimination, and corruption.

3.3. By Authorship

individual complaint;

collective complaint;

anonymous complaint — may be reviewed under a separate procedure by decision of the Dean, only where there are indications of a serious violation of the law or a threat to safety.

CHAPTER 4. CHANNELS FOR RECEIVING COMPLAINTS

9. Complainants are provided with the opportunity to file a complaint through the following channels:

the official Telegram bot of Termez State University and the Faculty of Physics and Mathematics;

the dedicated e-mail address of the Dean's Office for complaints;

the Trust Hotline;

the established weekly reception hours of the dean, deputy deans, and heads of department (the schedule is publicly displayed at the Faculty building and on the website);

through the Faculty Student Council and the Trade Union organization;

the "Suggestion Box" located at the Faculty building.

10. Information on all channels, including the responsible persons and a sample application, is permanently and visibly displayed on the Faculty website and at the Faculty building (in accordance with ESG Standard 1.8).

CHAPTER 5. RESPONSIBLE BODIES AND PERSONS

5.1. Complaints and Quality Assurance Group under the Dean's Office

11. A Complaints and Quality Assurance Group (hereinafter — the "Group"), headed by the Deputy Dean, operates under the Dean's Office. The Group registers all complaints, maintains an electronic register, monitors compliance with time limits, prepares statistical analysis, and submits the results for inclusion in the Faculty Quality Assurance system.

5.2. Faculty Ombudsperson (Trust Representative)

12. A Faculty Ombudsperson position is established for the protection of the rights and interests of students and staff. The Ombudsperson is independent in their activities, is directly accountable to the Faculty Council, advises complainants, mediates informal resolution, and submits recommendations to the dean regarding systemic issues.

5.3. Responsible Persons at Department Level

13. The head of the relevant department (General and Theoretical Physics, Applied Physics, Mathematical Analysis, Algebra and Geometry, Applied Mathematics and Informatics, and other departments) reviews first-level complaints (informal and initial formal) relating to their department.

5.4. Faculty Complaints Review Committee

14. A standing Committee, comprising faculty members, a representative of the Student Council, and representatives of the Trade Union and the legal service, is established to review formal complaints on their merits. The Committee, where possible, coordinates its work with the Faculty Quality Assurance Committee (ESG Standard 1.7 — stakeholder participation). A Committee member with a connection to the subject matter of a complaint is excluded from its review.

5.5. Faculty Appeals Committee

15. A Faculty Appeals Committee is formed to consider complaints against which the complainant disputes the initial decision. Its members are persons who did not participate in the initial decision (see Annex 3 to this Guideline).

5.6. University Trade Union Committee

16. Complaints concerning discrimination, pressure, and other serious ethical violations that have not been resolved at faculty level are reviewed under a separate procedure by the University Trade Union Committee.

5.7. The Dean

17. The Dean of the Faculty bears ultimate responsibility, at faculty level, for the effective operation of the complaints-handling system, its provision with the necessary resources, its compliance with international and national requirements, and for ensuring that the system's results are taken into account in management decisions; the Dean refers complex cases to the University Rectorate.

CHAPTER 6. PROCEDURE AND STAGES FOR REVIEWING COMPLAINTS

6.1. Stage 1. Informal (Prompt) Resolution

18. The complainant is first offered the opportunity to resolve the matter through informal communication directly with the relevant head of department or lecturer. This stage is carried out within 5 working days and does not require formal registration. Where necessary, the Faculty Ombudsperson provides mediation.

6.2. Stage 2. Filing and Registration of a Formal Complaint

19. A complaint that has not been resolved informally, or that by its nature requires a formal procedure directly, is submitted in writing or electronically in the prescribed form (Annex 1). It is registered by the Secretary of the Faculty Council within 1 working day, and the complainant is notified of the registration number and of its acceptance within 3 working days.

6.3. Stage 3. Preliminary Review

20. Within 5 working days, the complaint undergoes a preliminary review as to its relevance, completeness, and the absence of a conflict of interest, and is forwarded, according to its content, to the responsible body (the Faculty Council).

6.4. Stage 4. Investigation

21. The complaint is reviewed on its merits within 15 working days. In complex cases requiring additional documents or information, this period may, by a reasoned decision of the Head of the Group or the Deputy Dean

and in accordance with the Law “On Citizens’ Appeals,” be extended by up to a further 30 working days, of which the complainant is notified in writing. During the investigation, explanations are obtained from all parties concerned and the relevant documents are examined.

6.5. Stage 5. Decision-Making and Notification

22. Following the conclusion of the investigation, a reasoned written decision is adopted and delivered to the complainant within 3 working days from the date the decision is issued. The decision must indicate the right, procedure, and time limit for filing an appeal.

6.6. Stage 6. Appeal (Re-Review)

23. The complainant has the right to apply to the Faculty Appeals Committee within 10 working days from the day they become acquainted with the decision. An appeal may be filed on the following grounds: a procedural violation, the existence of significant new evidence, or manifest unreasonableness of the decision. The Appeals Committee adopts a final decision within 20 working days. The complainant has the right to attend the Committee’s meeting and to be assisted by a representative (companion).

6.7. Stage 7. Referral to External (Independent) Bodies

24. Where, after the internal procedures of the Faculty and the University have been completed, the complainant remains dissatisfied with the outcome, they have the right to apply to the following external bodies:

- the Ministry of Higher Education, Science and Innovation;
- the Commissioner for Human Rights (Ombudsman) under the Oliy Majlis of the Republic of Uzbekistan;
- the courts — in the manner established by legislation.

25. The University provides the complainant with an official letter (a completion letter) confirming that the internal procedures have been completed — this document serves as the basis for applying to external bodies (in accordance with the internationally recognized “Completion of Procedures” practice).

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CHAPTER 7. TIMETABLE OF DEADLINES

26. The stages of complaint review and their established deadlines are summarized in the table below:

No.	Stage	Responsible	Deadline
1	Informal resolution	Dean of the Faculty, Head of Department	5 working days
2	Registration	Secretary of the Faculty Council	1–3 working days
3	Preliminary review	Faculty Council working group	5 working days
4	Investigation	Faculty Council working group	15 working days (extendable up to +30 working days if necessary)
5	Decision and notification	Faculty Council	3 working days
6	Appeal	Appeals Committee	Filed within 10 working days; reviewed within 20 working days
7	External referral	Ministry / Ombudsman / Court	As established by legislation

27. As a general rule, it is recommended that a complaint be filed within 3 months of the date of the incident. The Faculty seeks to complete its internal procedures, in ordinary cases, within 90 calendar days from the date the complaint is registered.

CHAPTER 8. CONFIDENTIALITY AND PROTECTION OF PERSONAL DATA

28. All information gathered in connection with a complaint, including information about the complainant and any persons named in it, is disclosed only to the extent necessary for the investigation and only to officials directly involved in the process.

29. The requirements of the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Personal Data” are strictly observed when handling personal data. The electronic register of complaints is maintained with protection against unauthorized access.

30. The possibility of keeping the complainant’s name confidential may be considered, provided that this does not conflict with the need to ensure the fairness of the investigation; in such cases, the final decision must be based on objective evidence.

CHAPTER 9. PROTECTION FROM PRESSURE AND REPRISAL

31. Any measure in the form of demotion, disciplinary sanction, lowering of a grade, threat of expulsion, or any other form of pressure or discrimination against a person who has, in good faith, filed a complaint or participated in (given testimony in) its review is strictly prohibited.

32. The principle of “do no harm” is applied to complainants — it is ensured that a complainant does not suffer any disadvantage as a result of filing a complaint; where necessary, an alternative academic supervisor or group may be assigned to them.

33. Where facts of pressure or reprisal are established, disciplinary measures — including, in accordance with applicable legislation, termination of the employment contract — are applied to those responsible.

CHAPTER 10. UNFOUNDED AND FALSE COMPLAINTS

34. No measure is applied against a complainant in respect of a complaint filed in good faith but found, upon investigation, to be unfounded.

35. Where it is established that a complaint was filed with knowingly false information or with the deliberate intent to defame another person, the person responsible may be held liable in accordance with applicable legislation and the University’s internal documents.

CHAPTER 11. REPORTING, MONITORING AND SYSTEM IMPROVEMENT

36. The Group maintains an electronic register of all complaints, recording the subject of the complaint, the date received, the responsible person, the review deadline, and the final outcome.

37. The Group submits an analytical report on complaints statistics, key trends, and systemic issues to the Dean quarterly, and to the Faculty Council at least once a year. It is recommended that aggregated statistics (without personal data) be published on the Faculty website as part of the annual report.

38. Systemic issues identified through complaint analysis are included in an action plan for their resolution, and monitoring is established over its implementation. A regular internal audit of the effectiveness of the complaints-handling system is conducted in accordance with the requirements of ISO 10002:2018.

39. All officials responsible for receiving and reviewing complaints undergo professional-development training at least once a year in communication, dispute resolution, and conducting impartial investigations.

CHAPTER 12. FINAL PROVISIONS

40. This Guideline enters into force on the date of its adoption by the Faculty Council.

41. Amendments and additions to the Guideline are made on the recommendation of the Faculty Council. The Guideline is reviewed at least once every three years, and also where applicable legislation or the ESG standards change.

42. Where the provisions of this Guideline conflict with other internal documents of the University, the provision offering broader protection of the complainant's rights shall apply.

43. The text of the Guideline, the complaint-filing channels, and sample documents are permanently and openly made available on the Faculty's official website and official Telegram channel.

CHAPTER 13. COMPLIANCE WITH THE ESG STANDARDS

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44. This Guideline has been developed in accordance with the Standards and Guidelines for Quality Assurance in the European Higher Education Area (ESG, 2015) and is intended for use as supporting evidence in the Faculty's self-assessment report for program and institutional accreditation. The table below shows the correspondence between the relevant ESG standards and the articles of the Guideline:

ESG Standard	Substance of the requirement	Provision of the Guideline
1.1	Quality assurance policy and a continuous-improvement cycle	Chapter 2 (Article 8), Chapter 11 (Articles 36–38)
1.2	Involvement of stakeholders in the design and oversight of programs	Chapters 3–4, Article 5.4 (Committee composition)
1.3	Student-centred learning, assessment, and appeal procedures	Chapter 6 (Articles 18–25), Chapter 7
1.4	Rules pre-announced and consistently applied at every stage	Article 1.3, Chapter 4, Annex 1
1.7	Participation of students and staff in information gathering and analysis	Articles 5.2, 5.4, Chapter 2 (Article 8)
1.8	Open, accurate and up-to-date information on activities	Chapter 4 (Article 10), Chapter 12 (Article 43)
1.9	Regular monitoring and review of programs	Chapter 11 (Articles 37–38)

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ANNEXES

Annex 1. Complaint Application Form (Sample)

Field	To be completed
Registration number and date	(to be completed by the Group)
Full name of the complainant	_____
Category of complainant (student / faculty / staff)	_____
Department / year / group	_____
Contact details (phone, e-mail)	_____
Subject of the complaint (in accordance with Chapter 3)	_____
Date and place of the incident	_____
Detailed description of the complaint	_____
Measures previously taken (if any)	_____
Desired resolution	_____
Supporting documents attached	_____
Signature and date	_____

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Annex 2. Stages of Complaint Review (Summary Diagram)

No.	Stage	Responsible	Deadline
1	Informal resolution	Dean of the Faculty, Head of Department	5 working days
2	Registration	Secretary of the Faculty Council	1–3 working days
3	Preliminary review	Faculty Council working group	5 working days
4	Investigation	Faculty Council working group	15 working days (extendable up to +30 working days if necessary)
5	Decision and notification	Faculty Council	3 working days
6	Appeal	Appeals Committee	Filed within 10 working days; reviewed within 20 working days
7	External referral	Ministry / Ombudsman / Court	As established by legislation

Annex 3. Composition of the Faculty Appeals Committee (Sample)

Chair — the Dean (provided they were not involved in the initial decision);
one representative from the Department of Physics;
one representative from the Department of Mathematical Analysis;
one representative from the Department of Algebra and Geometry;
a representative of the Faculty Student Council;
a representative of the legal service (in an advisory capacity, without the right to vote);
a representative of the Faculty Council of Elders (as an observer).